

Canada Study Permit — Quick Guide

A plain-English checklist for Indian students applying for a Canadian study permit.

Are you eligible?

- An acceptance letter (LOA) from a Designated Learning Institution (DLI)
- Proof you can pay tuition + living costs
- Genuine intent to study and a clear plan
- Medical exam and police clearance, where required

Documents you'll need

- Valid passport
- Acceptance letter from your DLI
- Proof of funds (savings, loan sanction, GIC)
- Academic transcripts & certificates
- IELTS/PTE scorecard
- Statement of Purpose
- Passport-size photographs to spec

Proof of funds & GIC

You must show you can cover tuition and living expenses. Many students use a GIC (Guaranteed Investment Certificate) plus genuine, well-documented savings. Funds that appear suddenly or can't be explained are the most common reason files are questioned.

Why study permits get refused

- Weak or unexplained finances
- A vague or copied Statement of Purpose
- Course that doesn't fit your background
- Incomplete or inconsistent documents
- Unclear study intent

A realistic timeline

- 12+ months out: research & take IELTS/PTE
- 8–10 months: shortlist & apply
- 5–7 months: accept offer & arrange funds
- 3–4 months: submit a clean visa file

Want this checked for your exact profile? Book a free, no-pressure assessment with GCI — we'll map your shortlist, budget and timeline together.